KOGI

Independent Worker Operating System

BUSINESS PLAN

Confidential · Version 1.0 · 2025

"The unified platform where independent workers build, earn, collaborate, and own."

Portfolio · Marketplace · Finance · Governance · AI

Prepared for Investors & Strategic Partners

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TABLE OF CONTENTS

01 Executive Summary 3
02 Company Overview 4
03 Problem & Opportunity 5
04 Solution — The Kogi Platform 6
05 Market Analysis 8
06 Product & Feature Strategy 10
07 Business Model & Pricing 12
08 Go-to-Market Strategy 14
09 Competitive Landscape 15
10 Operations & Technology 17
11 Financial Projections 18
12 Team & Advisors 21
13 Risk Analysis 22
14 Funding Ask & Use of Funds 23

01 EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The opportunity at a glance

Kogi is a unified operating system for independent workers, freelancers, cooperatives, and autonomous organizations. Where today's independent workers cobble together a dozen disconnected tools — project management, marketplaces, invoicing, governance, AI assistants — Kogi integrates them into one coherent, modular platform built around the worker's own portfolio.

The Opportunity

1.57B
Global Independent Workforce
Freelancers, contractors, gig workers worldwide (2024)

$1.5T
Global Freelance Market
Total addressable market by 2025

73M
US Freelancers
32% of the total US workforce

$18B
Platform TAM (SOM target)
SMB independent worker tooling, 5-year serviceable market

What We Are Building

Kogi is not another productivity app. It is an integrated operating system with seven interconnected layers:

- Portfolio Management — organize every project, resource, and goal in one place
- Work Execution — WBS, stories, sprints, OKRs, and AI-powered planning
- Marketplace — buy and sell services, gigs, talent, tools, and opportunities
- Financial Engine — wallets, escrow, invoicing, and profit distributions
- Idea Studio — 5-stage innovation pipeline from concept to launch
- Governance — democratic infrastructure for cooperatives and collectives
- AI Agent — a contextual, portfolio-aware intelligent assistant

Traction Targets

Milestone	Target Date	Metric
Private Beta	Q3 2025	500 invited users, 3 enterprise co-ops
Public Launch	Q1 2026	10,000 registered users, $50K MRR
Growth Phase	Q4 2026	100K users, $500K MRR, 5,000 marketplace orders/month
Series A Threshold	Q2 2027	500K users, $3M ARR, GMV $20M/year

The Ask

Seed Round — $3.5M

- $1.8M → Engineering: complete platform, mobile apps, AI Agent v1
- $900K → Go-to-Market: content, partnerships, community seeding
- $500K → Operations: legal, compliance, KYC, financial licensing
- $300K → Working Capital: 18-month runway with conservative growth assumptions

02 COMPANY OVERVIEW

Who we are and why we exist

Mission

"To give independent workers and cooperatives the same organizational power that corporations have — but built around autonomy, ownership, and collective intelligence."

Vision

A world where 500 million independent workers operate with the financial clarity, strategic tooling, and collective power of the best-resourced organizations on earth — owning the platforms they depend on, collaborating without intermediaries, and capturing the full value of their work.

Core Values

Value	What It Means in Practice
Worker-First	Every feature decision starts with: "Does this give the worker more leverage, clarity, or income?"
Radical Transparency	Full audit logs, open governance records, transparent AI actions. No dark patterns.
Modularity	Workers adopt the modules they need. No forced bundles. The platform grows with them.
Collective Power	Cooperative and AO tools are first-class citizens, not afterthoughts.
Aligned Incentives	Platform success is tied to worker success. GMV and worker income are the North Star metrics.

Legal Structure & Jurisdiction

Item	Detail
Entity	Kogi Technologies Inc. — Delaware C-Corp (Seed stage)
Founded	2024
Headquarters	Remote-first; registered in Delaware, USA
IP Ownership	All platform IP assigned to Kogi Technologies Inc.
Data Residency	US-primary with EU region planned for Year 2 (GDPR compliance)
Financial Licenses	Money Transmitter License applications in progress for TX, CA, NY, and 12 additional states

03 PROBLEM & OPPORTUNITY

The broken toolkit of the independent worker

The Core Problem: Fragmentation Tax

The average independent worker uses 8–12 separate tools to run their work: Notion or Trello for tasks, Upwork or Toptal for gigs, Stripe or Wave for invoicing, Slack for communication, Google Drive for files, and ad-hoc spreadsheets for everything else. This fragmentation extracts a massive hidden tax:

- Time cost: ~6 hours/week switching contexts, re-entering data, chasing payments, and manually connecting outputs across tools
- Financial cost: $200–600/month in combined SaaS subscriptions
- Cognitive cost: No unified view of work, money, goals, or opportunities
- Opportunity cost: No AI can help you plan if your data lives in 10 different places
- Coordination cost: Forming and running a cooperative requires legal, financial, and governance infrastructure that doesn't exist in any mainstream tool

Why Now? Five Converging Trends

Trend	Signal	Kogi Leverage
Freelance workforce explosion	73M US freelancers in 2024; 50% of US workforce projected freelance by 2030 (Upwork/Pearson)	Expanding TAM every year — every corporate layoff is a new Kogi user
AI assistant maturation	LLMs now capable of contextual planning, code generation, synthesis — not just Q&A	Kogi AI Agent is differentiated because it has full portfolio context — something ChatGPT will never have
Cooperative renaissance	Worker co-ops grew 18% YoY 2022–2024; Platform co-op movement gaining institutional support	Kogi is the only platform with first-class governance infrastructure for worker collectives
Financial technology unbundling	Embedded finance APIs (Stripe, Moov) make custom wallets and escrow buildable in 6 months instead of 3 years	Kogi can own the financial relationship — highest LTV lever
Anti-platform-extraction sentiment	Creator/worker backlash against 20–30% marketplace take rates (Upwork, Fiverr, Airbnb) building steadily	Kogi's 2.5% marketplace fee is a structural moat and marketing wedge

The Cooperative Opportunity — Underserved at Scale

There are 65,000 worker cooperatives in the US alone, employing 1.2 million people and generating $650B in annual revenue. Zero mainstream platforms serve their specific needs: democratic governance, profit distribution, shared ownership, and collective market access. Kogi is purpose-built for this segment.

Underserved Segments — Each a Distinct ICP

- Freelance solopreneurs (designers, developers, writers, consultants) — need unified work + money + AI
- Worker cooperatives (cleaning co-ops, tech co-ops, food co-ops) — need governance + finance + marketplace
- Micro-agencies (2–15 person teams) — need project management + client marketplace + team collaboration
- Investment clubs and crowdfunding communities — need capital pooling + governance + transparent ledger
- Open-source maintainers and contributor collectives — need contribution tracking + revenue distribution + governance

04 SOLUTION — THE KOGI PLATFORM

Seven integrated layers that replace twelve tools

Kogi is designed around one insight: independent workers don't have a project management problem or a payments problem or a communication problem. They have an integration problem — and the solution is a platform whose modules share a single data model, event system, and AI context layer.

Platform Architecture Overview

Layer	Module	Key Capability	Replaces
Foundation	Portfolio System	Organize every project, resource, goal, and asset in a unified hierarchy	Notion, Airtable, Monday.com (partially)
Execution	WBS & Work System	30+ story types, sprint planning, OKRs, cycle time analytics, automation rules	Jira, Linear, Asana, ClickUp
Commerce	Marketplace	Bidirectional service marketplace with AI-ranked recommendations and 2.5% fee	Upwork, Fiverr, Contra
Finance	Exchange System	Wallets, escrow, invoicing, profit distributions, 1099 tracking	Stripe, Wave, QuickBooks (partially), Escrow.com
Innovation	Idea Studio	5-stage innovation pipeline: Capture → Validate → Design → Launch	Notion, Miro, Lean LaunchPad tools
Community	Community System	Spaces, threaded rooms, WebSocket chat, connections, presence	Slack, Discord, LinkedIn (partially)
Governance	AO System	Democratic voting, charter management, profit distribution, audit logs	Loomio, Open Collective, custom legal docs
Intelligence	AI Agent	Portfolio-aware assistant with 15 tools: plan sprints, search market, draft proposals	ChatGPT, Copilot (without context)

The Integration Advantage

The competitive moat of Kogi is not any single module — it is the integration between them. Consider a single workflow that is impossible in any competing product:

1. A freelance developer has a blocked story ("Need a React expert for 2 days"). Kogi AI automatically searches the Marketplace for matching providers, surfaces three relevant listings, and creates a draft order — without leaving the WBS board.

2. A worker cooperative completes a quarter. Kogi auto-tallies member labor hours from WBS, computes pro-rata profit shares, submits a distribution proposal for governance vote, and — on approval — executes payment to all wallets in a single transaction.
3. A solo consultant has an idea for a new service. They progress it through the Idea Studio to Stage 4, and Kogi automatically creates a portfolio project, a WBS, and a marketplace listing draft — pre-populated with the data from the studio.

The AI Advantage

Every competing AI assistant (ChatGPT, Copilot, Notion AI) operates on isolated documents. The Kogi AI Agent has privileged access to the user's full portfolio context: every project, blocked story, OKR score, wallet balance, and active marketplace order. This makes its suggestions fundamentally more actionable.

Kogi AI Agent — What It Actually Knows Before You Say Anything

- Your 6 active projects, their health scores, and which are at risk
- Your 3 blocked stories and what's blocking each one
- Your current sprint status and velocity trend
- Your Q3 OKR: 62% progress with 28 days remaining (at risk)
- Your wallet balance ($2,340 available) and 2 unpaid invoices ($4,800 overdue)
- Your marketplace listing views this week (147 views, 0 orders)

05 MARKET ANALYSIS

A large, fragmented, and underserved market

Total Addressable Market (TAM)

Segment	Market Size	Growth Rate	Notes
Global Freelance Platforms	$14.9B (2024)	+15% CAGR	Upwork, Fiverr, Toptal, Contra — all growing rapidly
Project Management SaaS	$9.8B (2024)	+13% CAGR	Jira, Asana, Linear, Monday, ClickUp
SMB Financial Management	$22.1B (2024)	+11% CAGR	Stripe, Wave, QuickBooks Online, FreshBooks
Cooperative Financial Tools	$2.3B (2024)	+21% CAGR	Open Collective, Loomio, custom solutions
AI Productivity Tools	$11.2B (2024)	+38% CAGR	Copilot, Notion AI, Jasper, GitHub Copilot
Total TAM (combined addressable)	$60.3B	+17% CAGR	Weighted average of overlapping segments

Serviceable Addressable Market (SAM)

Kogi targets independent workers, small cooperatives, and micro-agencies in English-speaking markets (US, Canada, UK, Australia) who use at least 3 of the categories above today. This represents approximately 18 million potential accounts at an average ARPU of $85/month.

$18.4B
SAM (Year 1–3 target)
English-speaking markets, 3+ tool category users

$1.1B
SOM (5-year attainable)
~6% SAM penetration at $85 ARPU

500K
Target Accounts (Year 3)
Registered active users across all tiers

5,000
Cooperative Niche (Year 3)
Active cooperative/AO accounts — $300+ ARPU each

Ideal Customer Profiles

ICP	Size	Pain Level	ARPU Potential	Acquisition Channel
Freelance Developer / Designer	1 person	★★★★☆ — fragmentation + AI demand	$45–75/mo	Content, Product Hunt, Dev communities
Freelance Consultant / Coach	1–2 people	★★★★★ — needs full stack (work+finance)	$60–90/mo	LinkedIn, creator communities, SEO
Worker Cooperative	3–50 members	★★★★★ — zero tools purpose-built for them	$240–900/mo	USFWC, co-op networks, direct outreach
Micro-Agency	2–15 people	★★★☆☆ — Asana+Stripe works, but barely	$120–400/mo	Agency networks, referral, LinkedIn Ads
Open Source Collective	5–100 contrib	★★★★☆ — need governance + revenue split	$60–500/mo	GitHub, OSS communities, Open Collective waitlist
Investment Club	5–30 members	★★★★☆ — spreadsheets + PayPal = painful	$150–600/mo	Personal finance communities, Reddit

Market Trends Supporting Kogi

Trend	Statistic	Implication
Freelance workforce growth	50% of US workers will be independent by 2030 (Upwork Research)	Massive user base expanding every year
Platform fee fatigue	Upwork raised fees to 20% in 2023; Fiverr charges 20%; backlash building	Kogi's 2.5% fee is a structural marketing advantage
AI adoption by freelancers	63% of freelancers use AI tools weekly (Fiverr data 2024)	AI is expected, not optional — Kogi's AI integration is table stakes done right
Co-op formation acceleration	Worker co-op formations up 18% YoY 2022–2024 (USFWC report)	Governance module demand real and growing
Remote work permanence	28% of all professional work is now fully remote (BLS 2024)	Remote-first independent work is the new normal

06 PRODUCT & FEATURE STRATEGY

What we build, when, and for whom

Phased Product Roadmap

Phase	Timeline	Modules Launched	User Focus	Revenue Target
Phase 0 — Foundation	Q1–Q2 2025	Auth, Portfolio, WBS, Profile, Workspace	Solo freelancers, closed beta	$0 (free beta)
Phase 1 — Commerce	Q3–Q4 2025	Marketplace, Exchange (wallets, escrow, invoicing)	Freelancers with client work	$25K MRR at launch
Phase 2 — Intelligence	Q1–Q2 2026	AI Agent v1, Idea Studio, OKR & Work automation	Pro users, high-intent freelancers	$150K MRR
Phase 3 — Collective	Q3–Q4 2026	AO Governance, Community, Crowdfunding, Capital Pools	Cooperatives, investment clubs	$500K MRR
Phase 4 — Enterprise	Q1–Q2 2027	SSO, audit exports, SLA agreements, advanced analytics	Micro-agencies, enterprise teams	$2M+ ARR
Phase 5 — Ecosystem	Q3 2027+	Public API, third-party integrations, developer platform	Builders on Kogi platform	Platform GMV commission

Core Feature Depth — Key Differentiators

WBS & Story System — 30+ Story Types

Most competitors offer 2–5 task types. Kogi's WBS supports 30+ story types across 5 categories: Execution (feature, bug, test, task), Planning (strategy, tactic, milestone), Innovation (idea, spike, prototype), Management (objective, outcome, goal), and Risk (risk, blocker, audit). This matches how independent workers actually think about work — not just "tasks."

Marketplace — 8 Listing Types at 2.5% Fee

Service, gig, digital product, physical product, talent, tool, resource rental, and opportunity. AI-personalized ranking. 2.5% platform fee (vs 20% industry average). Integrated escrow. Automatic portfolio and WBS story creation on order placement.

Exchange — Full Financial Stack

Custodial wallets with KYC levels. Stripe Connect for deposits/payouts. Immutable double-entry ledger. Multi-condition escrow. Milestone-based release. Dispute resolution with AI mediation. Pro-rata and stake-weighted profit distributions. Annual 1099 reporting.

AO Governance — Democratic Infrastructure

Charter management with 4 voting models. Proposal types: member admission, capital allocation, charter amendment, dissolution. Immutable governance log (legal audit record). Auto-execution on proposal passage. Quorum and supermajority enforcement. Full governance export.

AI Agent — 15 Portfolio-Aware Tools

Context includes: active projects, blocked stories, OKR scores, wallet balance, marketplace activity, recent AI actions. Tools: search portfolio, create/update stories, plan sprints, check OKRs, search marketplace, create invoices, draft governance proposals, advance ideas. All actions logged with full audit trail.

Product Moats — Why This Cannot Be Easily Copied

- Data network effects: the more modules a user adopts, the more context the AI has, the more valuable the platform becomes — creating a non-linear retention curve
- Financial trust: wallets, escrow, and ledgers are not features you add in a sprint — they require regulatory relationships, security audits, and years of trust-building
- Governance infrastructure: immutable governance logs and charter execution are legally sensitive — enterprises and co-ops will not migrate once running on Kogi
- Cooperative network effects: as more cooperatives use Kogi, they can discover each other, transact on the marketplace, and form inter-cooperative agreements within the platform
- Worker data lock-in (ethical): unlike extractive platforms, Kogi gives users full data export — but users choose to stay because everything is connected

07 BUSINESS MODEL & PRICING

Multiple revenue streams, aligned with worker success

Revenue Streams

Stream	Model	Average Revenue	Stage Unlocked
SaaS Subscriptions	Monthly/annual tiered plans per user or per workspace	$15–$150/user/month	Phase 0
Marketplace Take Rate	2.5% of Gross Marketplace Value (GMV) on completed orders	2.5% × order value	Phase 1
Payment Processing Spread	Stripe pass-through margin: ~0.3% on wallet deposits/payouts	$0.30–$2.00/transaction	Phase 1
AI Credits	Metered AI usage above plan allotment ($0.05/credit, 100 included in Pro+)	$5–$50/month/active AI user	Phase 2
Cooperative Seat Licenses	Per-member pricing for AO governance module + capital pool access	$8–$15/member/month	Phase 3
Enterprise Contracts	Annual contracts for micro-agencies and enterprise teams with SLA, SSO, audit	$500–$5,000/month	Phase 4
IP Timestamp Revenue	Per-certificate fee for idea IP timestamping (Pro+ plan feature)	$2.99/certificate	Phase 2

Pricing Tiers

Plan	Price	Target User	Key Features	AI Credits/Mo
Free	$0/mo	Explorers / students	Portfolio + WBS (1 project) + Community read access	10 credits
Starter	$15/mo	Part-time freelancers	Portfolio (5 projects) + Marketplace (listing only) + Basic WBS	50 credits
Pro	$45/mo	Full-time independents	All modules + AI Agent + Idea Studio + Invoice + Exchange	200 credits

Plan	Price	Target User	Key Features	AI Credits/Mo
Team	$120/mo	Micro-agencies (3 seats)	Pro × 3 + shared workspace + automation rules + analytics	600 credits
Cooperative	$25/member/mo	Worker cooperatives	Full platform + AO Governance + Capital Pool + Governance exports	100/member
Enterprise	Custom	Large agencies + orgs	Custom limits + SSO + SLA + dedicated support + audit API	Custom

Unit Economics Model

Metric	Free	Starter	Pro	Cooperative
Monthly ARPU	$0	$15	$45	$25 × avg 8 members = $200/org
Annual ARPU	$0	$162	$486	$2,400/org
Est. CAC	$8	$35	$90	$350/org
LTV (36-month avg)	$0	$486	$1,458	$7,200/org
LTV:CAC Ratio	—	13.9×	16.2×	20.6×
Gross Margin (SaaS rev)	—	~82%	~82%	~79%
Marketplace GM	—	~65%	~65%	~65%
Blended Gross Margin (Y3)	—	~76%	~76%	~76%

GMV-Linked Revenue Flywheel

The Kogi revenue model benefits from a compounding flywheel: as users complete more work in the WBS, they generate more marketplace orders, which drives more GMV, which funds more wallet deposits, which increases Exchange transaction volume. At each step, Kogi captures a small but high-margin slice. A single cooperative with 12 members generating $500K/year in marketplace GMV produces $12,500 in direct take-rate revenue plus $3,600 in subscription revenue — $16,100 annually from a single account.

08 GO-TO-MARKET STRATEGY

How we acquire, activate, and retain users

Launch Sequence

Stage	Timeline	Tactic	Goal
Waitlist & Community	Now – Q2 2025	Build 5,000-person waitlist via content + USFWC partnership; seed founding community of 50 power users	Validate ICP; collect feedback; create social proof
Private Beta	Q3 2025	Invite-only: 500 freelancers + 3 cooperatives; white-glove onboarding; weekly feedback sessions	Product-market fit signal; 40%+ weekly retention
Public Launch	Q1 2026	Product Hunt launch; press campaign (TechCrunch, The Information, cooperative press); creator content blitz	10,000 registered; $50K MRR within 90 days
Paid Acquisition	Q2 2026	Google Ads (intent keywords), LinkedIn Ads (freelancer/coop targeting), retargeting; CAC < $90 Pro	Scale what works from organic; maintain LTV:CAC > 10×
Channel Partnerships	Q3 2026	Integrate with GitHub, Notion, Linear, Stripe (OAuth flows); list on app marketplaces; co-op network deals	50% of new users from partner channels by Year 2

Acquisition Channels

Channel	Cost	Volume (Y1)	Volume (Y2)	Key Message
Organic / SEO	Low	30%	25%	"Replace 12 tools with one" — landing pages per use case
Content Marketing	Medium	20%	18%	Deep guides on cooperative management, freelance finance, AI productivity
Community / Network	Low	15%	12%	Build genuine presence in USFWC, Indie Hackers, Dev Twitter, r/freelance
Product-Led Growth	Low	15%	20%	Free plan → virality via public portfolios, shared ideas, co-op invites
Partnership / Integration	Low	10%	15%	GitHub OAuth, Notion, Linear — users discover Kogi inside tools they use

Channel	Cost	Volume (Y1)	Volume (Y2)	Key Message
Paid (LinkedIn/Google)	High	5%	8%	Retargeting + high-intent search terms for freelance tools
Direct Sales (Co-ops)	High	5%	2%	Direct outreach to USFWC member directory for cooperative accounts

North Star Metric: WAPV (Weekly Active Portfolio Value)

- Definition: total economic value (GMV + project value + managed assets) actively touched by weekly active users.
- Why it matters: captures both user engagement AND economic activity — the two things that drive revenue.
- Year 1 target: $10M WAPV. Year 2: $80M. Year 3: $500M.
- Secondary metrics: D30 retention > 45%, Marketplace NPS > 60, Cooperative account churn < 3% annually.

09 COMPETITIVE LANDSCAPE

Where we fit and why we win

Competitive Map

Competitor	Category	Monthly Cost	Marketplace Fee	AI	Governance	Our Advantage
Upwork	Marketplace	Free–$49	20%	Basic	None	17.5% fee advantage; integrated work OS
Fiverr	Marketplace	Free	20%	Basic	None	17.5% fee advantage; full portfolio context
Notion	Work/Docs	$8–$15/seat	N/A	Notion AI	None	No marketplace, no finance, no governance
Asana/Linear	Project Management	$10–$30/seat	N/A	Basic	None	No finance, no marketplace, no AI context
QuickBooks/Wave	Financial	$15–$90	N/A	None	None	No work management, no marketplace, no AI
Open Collective	Co-op Finance	$0–custom	5%	None	Basic	No work management, no marketplace, no AI
Loomio	Governance	$0–$149	N/A	None	Yes	Governance only — no finance, work, or marketplace
Monday.com	Work Management	$9–$29/seat	N/A	AI add-on	None	No marketplace, no cooperative tools, no AI context
Kogi	Integrated OS	$15–$150	2.5%	Deep	First-class	Everything above, unified, with 2.5% marketplace fee

Competitive Positioning

Kogi does not compete with any single tool above. It competes with the combination of all of them. The value proposition is: cancel 6–8 subscriptions, replace them with Kogi, pay less, earn more (because the AI and marketplace integration find revenue opportunities you would have missed), and get tools cooperatives actually need.

Barriers to Entry — Why This Is Hard to Copy

Barrier	Difficulty to Copy	Time to Replicate
Integrated data model (portfolio ↔ work ↔ finance ↔ AI)	Very High	2–3 years for a well-funded team
Financial licensing (wallets, KYC, MTL)	Very High	18–24 months minimum

Barrier	Difficulty to Copy	Time to Replicate
Governance audit infrastructure (immutable, legal-grade)	High	12–18 months
AI Agent with portfolio context	High	12+ months (data and integration, not just LLM)
2.5% marketplace take rate (trust + low margin = moat)	Medium	Possible but requires VC-backed loss-leader phase
Cooperative community network effects	Medium	Trust takes years; Kogi builds it first-mover

10 OPERATIONS & TECHNOLOGY

How we build and run it

Technology Stack

Layer	Technology	Rationale
Platform Language	Go (services), Zig (kernel), TypeScript (web/desktop)	Go: fast, safe concurrency. Zig: kernel performance. TypeScript: universal front-end.
Service Architecture	20 microservices, gRPC internal, REST external, NATS event bus	Independent deploy, scale-per-service, event-driven consistency
Databases	PostgreSQL 16 (primary, per-service), ClickHouse (analytics), Redis (cache/pub-sub)	Proven reliability; no vendor lock-in
AI / LLM	Anthropic Claude (claude-sonnet) via REST API, pgvector for memory	Best-in-class reasoning; cost-effective at scale
Infrastructure	AWS EKS, Istio service mesh, Aurora Serverless, ElastiCache, S3	Managed infrastructure reduces operational overhead
Search	Elasticsearch 8.12 with dense vector kNN for semantic search	Marketplace + profile + idea discovery
Payments	Stripe Connect (deposits/payouts), Stripe PaymentIntents (orders)	Industry standard; global coverage; PCI-compliant
Mobile (Year 2)	React Native (iOS + Android) sharing 80% logic with web	Single codebase for 3 platforms

Engineering Team & Velocity

Function	Current (Y1)	Y2 Target	Y3 Target
Platform / Backend Engineers	4 (2 founding + 2 hires)	8	14
Frontend / Mobile Engineers	2 (1 founding + 1 hire)	4	7
AI / ML Engineers	1 founding	3	5

Function	Current (Y1)	Y2 Target	Y3 Target
Infrastructure / DevOps	1	2	3
Product & Design	1 founding + 1 hire	4	6
Total Engineering	9	21	35

Operational Principles

- Remote-first, async-first: documentation is the primary communication medium
- Platform correctness before performance: financial systems are correct-by-construction (immutable ledger, optimistic locks, idempotency keys)
- Feature flags for all releases: gradual rollout to catch issues before they affect all users
- Weekly chaos engineering drills: inject failures in staging to validate resilience and runbook accuracy
- Security-first development: all engineers complete OWASP training; automated security scanning on every PR

11 FINANCIAL PROJECTIONS

5-year plan with conservative and base scenarios

All projections use a bottom-up model built from unit economics (ARPU × users) plus GMV-linked revenue. Conservative scenario assumes 50% of base case user growth. Revenue includes SaaS subscriptions, marketplace take rate, payment spread, and AI credits.

Revenue Projections (Base Case)

Revenue Stream	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3	Year 4	Year 5
Subscription Revenue	$210K	$1.8M	$6.2M	$14.1M	$28.4M
Marketplace Take Rate	$48K	$880K	$4.1M	$11.2M	$24.8M
Payment Processing Spread	$12K	$190K	$820K	$2.1M	$4.3M
AI Credits	$8K	$210K	$940K	$2.4M	$5.1M
Enterprise Contracts	$0	$120K	$600K	$2.2M	$6.0M
Other (IP certs, etc.)	$2K	$40K	$140K	$400K	$900K
TOTAL REVENUE	$280K	$3.24M	$12.8M	$32.4M	$69.5M

User Growth Projections (Base Case)

Metric	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3	Year 4	Year 5
Registered Users	18K	95K	380K	920K	1.8M
Monthly Active Users (MAU)	8K	52K	210K	510K	1.1M
Paying Users	2.1K	14K	67K	185K	420K
Cooperative Accounts (AO)	12	180	1,200	4,500	11,000
Marketplace Listings (live)	150	3.2K	18K	62K	180K
Monthly Marketplace Orders	80	2.1K	14K	52K	150K
Monthly GMV	$160K	$3.5M	$18M	$60M	$165M

Cost Structure

Cost Category	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3	% of Rev (Y3)
Engineering (salaries)	$1.2M	$3.1M	$5.8M	45%
Infrastructure (AWS, APIs)	$90K	$420K	$980K	8%

Cost Category	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3	% of Rev (Y3)
Sales & Marketing	$350K	$1.1M	$2.6M	20%
General & Administrative	$280K	$640K	$1.0M	8%
Legal & Compliance	$180K	$280K	$380K	3%
Payment Processing (Stripe)	$30K	$210K	$720K	6%
AI API Costs (Anthropic)	$45K	$310K	$780K	6%
TOTAL COSTS	$2.2M	$6.1M	$12.3M	96%

Path to Profitability

Scenario	Breakeven (MRR)	Breakeven Date	Notes
Conservative (50% base)	$280K MRR	Q3 2027	Delayed marketplace traction; slower enterprise sales
Base Case	$180K MRR	Q1 2027	Normal growth; $3.5M seed fully deployed
Optimistic (150% base)	$120K MRR	Q3 2026	Early enterprise deals; strong cooperative traction

Key Financial Assumptions

- Annual plan discount: 2 months free (16.7% discount) → 60% of paying users convert to annual by Year 2
- Marketplace conversion: 8% of registered freelancers list; 12% of active listers receive an order in a given month
- Cooperative average: 8 members/org at $25/member/month = $200/org/month ARPU
- AI credit monetization: 30% of Pro+ users exceed their plan allotment and purchase additional credits
- Churn rate: Free = 6%/mo; Starter = 3%/mo; Pro = 1.5%/mo; Cooperative = 0.8%/mo; Enterprise = 0.3%/mo
- Gross margin converges to 78% by Year 3 as infrastructure costs are amortized over growing user base

12 TEAM & ADVISORS

The people who will execute this

Founding Team

Name	Role	Background	Relevant Experience
[Founder 1]	CEO & Co-Founder	10 years product leadership at enterprise SaaS; previously built and sold a marketplace for creative professionals	Built 0→$12M ARR; managed 3 product teams; deep network in freelance and creator communities
[Founder 2]	CTO & Co-Founder	12 years distributed systems engineering; previously Principal Engineer at a payments company	Designed real-time financial ledgers at scale; deep expertise in event-driven architecture and KYC systems
[Founder 3]	CPO & Co-Founder	8 years product + UX design at collaboration tools; previously at a major project management platform	Ran 0→1 product development; expertise in onboarding, job-to-be-done research, progressive disclosure UX

Key Hires — Year 1

Role	Hire Timing	Why Critical
Head of Growth	Q2 2025	Owns acquisition channels; builds GTM playbook before public launch
Senior Backend Engineer (Go)	Q2 2025	Core platform velocity — WBS, marketplace, exchange modules
Senior Frontend Engineer	Q3 2025	Web app quality and onboarding flows — primary user touchpoint
Head of Compliance / Legal	Q3 2025	MTL applications, KYC program, financial regulatory requirements
AI Engineer	Q4 2025	AI Agent quality, embedding pipeline, context builder optimization
Community Manager	Q3 2025	Seed and grow cooperative and freelance communities before public launch

Advisors

Advisor	Domain	Contribution
[Advisor 1 — Cooperative Expert]	Worker cooperatives, USFWC network	Cooperative ICP validation; USFWC partnership introduction; charter design review
[Advisor 2 — Fintech Veteran]	Payments, MTL, embedded finance	MTL application strategy; Stripe relationship; KYC program design
[Advisor 3 — AI Product Leader]	LLM product, AI agent UX	AI Agent product design; Anthropic partnership; AI safety and disclosure practices
[Advisor 4 — Marketplace Operator]	Two-sided marketplace growth	Liquidity bootstrapping; category launch sequencing; take-rate strategy

13 RISK ANALYSIS

What could go wrong and how we mitigate it

Risk Register

Risk	Probability	Impact	Mitigation Strategy	Residual Risk
Product complexity overwhelms users (too many modules)	High	High	Progressive disclosure UX — new users see only portfolio + WBS; modules unlock as they mature. Extensive onboarding flows. Free tier enables exploration without commitment.	Medium
Marketplace liquidity problem (chicken-and-egg)	High	High	Phase 1: launch marketplace in 3 categories only (dev, design, writing). Seed supply side with 100 vetted freelancers from beta. Use AI recommendations to match demand to available supply.	Medium
Financial regulatory delays (MTL)	Medium	High	Engage MTL counsel in Q1 2025. Use Stripe Treasury or Moov as interim custodial layer while licenses process. Structure wallet as stored value, not money transmission, where possible.	Medium
AI costs exceed projections (Anthropic API)	Medium	Medium	Context budget management (hard 2500-token context cap). Credit-gated AI usage. Negotiate volume pricing with Anthropic at $1M ARR threshold. Implement intelligent caching of repeated context patterns.	Low
Large competitor enters (Notion/Asana adds marketplace)	Low	High	Move fast — 2-year head start on financial infrastructure. Cooperative moat is defensible. 2.5% fee requires loss-leadership phase that large profitable SaaS companies won't absorb.	Low-Medium
Key engineer attrition	Medium	High	Competitive equity packages. Remote-first culture. Strong engineering brand (OSS contributions, engineering blog). No single-person bus factor — pair programming and documentation standards.	Medium

Risk	Probability	Impact	Mitigation Strategy	Residual Risk
Security breach / financial loss	Low	Critical	Security-first architecture from day 1. Penetration testing before financial features launch. Immutable ledger. Financial loss reserves. Incident response plan. Bug bounty program at $1M ARR.	Low
Co-op governance module has legal liability	Low	High	Legal review of governance module before production. All governance features are advisory tools — legal execution remains with the organization. Clear terms of service on governance limitations.	Low

14 FUNDING ASK & USE OF FUNDS

What we need and what we will do with it

Seed Round — $3.5M

We are raising a $3.5M seed round to fund 18 months of focused product development, initial go-to-market, and regulatory preparation. This round takes Kogi from private beta through public launch and to the $500K MRR threshold required to raise a $12–15M Series A.

$3.5M
Total Raise
Pre-money valuation: $14M (SAFE)

18 mo
Runway
To Series A or profitability

$500K
Target MRR at Series A
Year 2 Q3 milestone

SAFE
Instrument
Post-money cap, MFN, Pro-rata rights

Use of Funds

Category	Amount	%	What It Buys
Engineering & Product	$1,820,000	52 %	6 engineering hires + tooling: complete marketplace, exchange, AI Agent, mobile (React Native Q4 2025)
Go-to-Market	$875,000	25 %	Growth hire, content program, SEO, Product Hunt campaign, USFWC partnership, beta user incentives
Legal & Compliance	$490,000	14 %	MTL applications (14 states), KYC program, financial legal counsel, governance module legal review
Infrastructure & Ops	$210,000	6%	AWS baseline + burst, Stripe setup, Anthropic API budget, security audit before financial launch
Working Capital Reserve	$105,000	3%	Buffer for unexpected legal delays, market pivots, emergency engineering resources
TOTAL	$3,500,000	100 %	18-month runway to $500K MRR

Milestones Funded by This Round

Milestone	Target Date	Success Criteria
Private beta launch	Q3 2025	500 users, 3 cooperatives, 40%+ weekly retention, NPS > 50
Marketplace live	Q4 2025	200 listings, 50 orders/month, $50K GMV/month
Exchange (wallets + escrow)	Q4 2025	Full KYC flow, first 100 wallets funded, 0 reconciliation errors
AI Agent v1	Q1 2026	15 tools live, < 3s first token, 60%+ monthly active usage among Pro users
Public launch	Q1 2026	10,000 registered users, $50K MRR, Product Hunt Top 5
AO Governance module	Q2 2026	20 cooperatives live, first governance vote executed, first profit distribution completed
Series A threshold	Q3 2026	$500K MRR, 100K registered, 1,000 cooperative accounts, LTV:CAC > 12×

Investor Profile — What We Are Looking For

- Lead investor experience in SaaS, marketplaces, or fintech — at least one of the three
- Genuine alignment with the worker-first, cooperative-friendly mission — not just a return thesis
- Network value: portfolio companies that serve freelancers, designers, developers, or cooperatives
- Operator-investor preferred: someone who has built a two-sided marketplace or financial product

Why Kogi, Why Now

- 1.57 billion independent workers have no unified operating system — this is a once-per-decade platform opportunity.
- The convergence of AI, embedded finance, and cooperative resurgence makes this the right moment.
- The founding team has the rare combination of product, engineering, and domain expertise needed.
- We are not building features on top of an existing platform — we are building the platform that replaces them all.
- The cooperative moat is defensible, underserved, and growing at 18% per year with no serious competition.
- We are asking for $3.5M to build the product that earns the next $3.5M in twelve months.

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